CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

# Core Item Update: Lehengas 2026–28

Lehengas are getting lighter and easier to wear across several functions.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



# Overview

Lehengas are getting lighter and easier to wear across several functions. Cape lehengas and light organza lead the rise; ombré skirts peak in Summer 27; fish-cut skirts are the emerging silhouette. Crop-top sets have peaked and begin to fade.

| 4 | 2 | 1 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| INVEST | TEST | MAINTAIN | REDUCE |

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

# The details

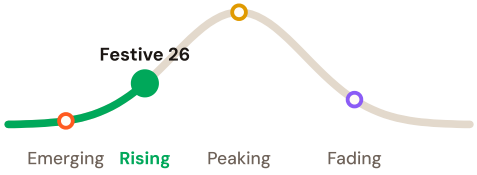
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

## Cape lehengas

Lehengas with a cape-style dupatta or overlay. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



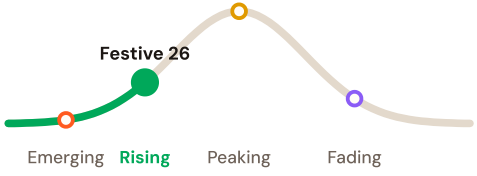

Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Peaking
Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Fading



INVEST RISING

## Ombré and dual-tone lehengas

Skirts shading from a deep base into a lighter hem. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Peaking
Festive 27 Fading
Summer 28
Festive 28



INVEST RISING

## Light organza lehengas

Airy organza lehengas for sangeet and day functions. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




Festive 26 Rising
Summer 27 Peaking
Festive 27 Peaking
Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Fading

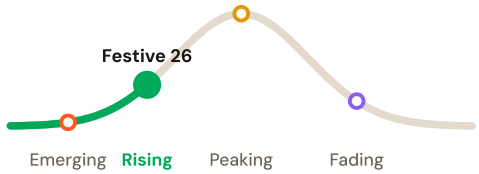


INVEST RISING

## Black mirror-work lehengas

Black lehengas worked in mirrors, hand embroidery and metallic accents, with a bralette blouse and sheer sequinned dupatta, as worn by Kriti Sanon closing Abhinav Mishra's Into the Wild 2026, New Delhi, 24 Oct 2026. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.

| | |
|---|---|
| Fading | – |



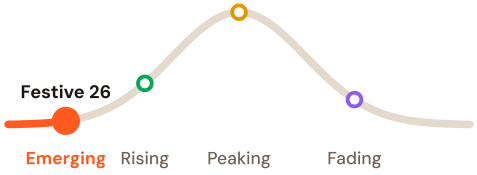

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26<br>Rising | Summer 27<br>Peaking | Festive 27<br>Rising |
| Summer 28<br>Peaking | Festive 28<br>Fading | |



TEST EMERGING

## Fish-cut lehenga skirts

Fitted through the hip, flaring at the knee for a longer line. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26<br>Emerging | Summer 27<br>Rising | Festive 27<br>Rising |
| Summer 28<br>Peaking | Festive 28<br>Peaking | |

TEST EMERGING

## Tiger-stripe fishtail lehengas

Black-and-gold stripe-patterned lehengas cut close through the hip and flared at the hem, worn with a sheer dupatta, as on Janhvi Kapoor at Manish Malhotra's Diwali party, Mumbai, Nov 2026. Early signal. Trial in small drops and premium lines.



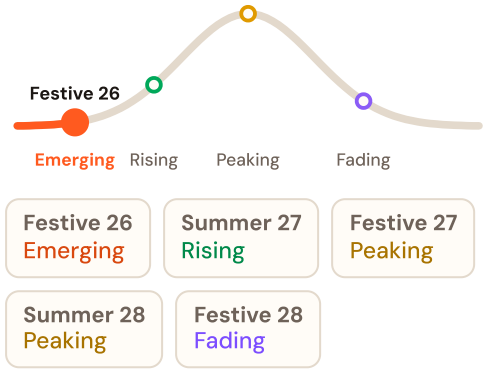
MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Crop-top lehenga sets

Shorter blouses with high-waisted skirts. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26<br>Peaking | Summer 27<br>Peaking | Festive 27<br>Fading |
| Summer 28<br>Fading | Festive 28<br>– | |




## How to update your lehengas range

- Lead with cape and light organza lehengas for sangeet and day functions.
- Test fish-cut skirts in a small premium drop.
- Keep can-can light and add side zips and drawstrings for fit.
- Reduce crop-top sets from Festive 27.

## What to check in lehengas development

- **Skirt panels and flare:** kalis (panels) and can-can control volume; specify flare in metres.
- **Waist and length:** leave seam allowance for alterations.
- **Blouse:** offer padded, corset or simple blouse options.
- **Weight:** state the approximate finished weight for comfort.

## Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Organza and tulle for light volume
- Raw silk and velvet for winter weddings
- Georgette for fluid, lighter lehengas
- Brocade for traditional bridal

## The global view

Indian lehengas sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

## Common questions

**How heavy should a bridal lehenga be?** Lighter is in demand. Many brides now prefer weights that are comfortable for long ceremonies, achieved with lighter bases and structured volume.

**Which lehengas suit guests?** Light georgette, organza and printed lehengas in pastels or jewel tones that can be re-worn.

See every lehengas detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).